



ALUMNI SCHOOLS GOLF CHALLENGE

TOURNAMENT RULES, REGULATIONS AND CONDITIONS

INAUGURAL SEASON 2026/27

Celebrating excellence. Competing exclusively. Honouring tradition.

Foreword

Welcome to the inaugural Alumni Schools Golf Challenge! We are thrilled to launch this exciting, purely competitive tournament that brings together alumni from South African schools to celebrate our shared traditions, excellence on the course, and the spirit of friendly rivalry. Whether you are teeing off for bragging rights or aiming for the SA Final, we aim to create an enjoyable, fair, and memorable experience for everyone involved. Thank you for joining us—let's make this season unforgettable!

1. Introduction

- 1.1 The Alumni Schools Golf Challenge is a fun, schools-based golf tournament exclusively for alumni of South African schools.
- 1.2 It is played in Better ball Matchplay format across divisions and managed entirely through our custom and mobile friendly website.
- 1.3 Registration opens on by 2 April 2026,
- 1.4 By registering, you agree to these guidelines in full—we appreciate your participation!

2. Overview and General Terms & Conditions

- 2.1 We aim to build a tournament known for its integrity and enjoyment. We reserve the right of admission.
- 2.2 This is purely about competition, great golf and rekindling old friendships.

3. Team compilation and substitutions

- 3.1 Both players must be from the same school and each player should have spent a minimum of 3 years in the school they are representing.

3.2 If a player in a pair cannot play in any round due to health, bereavement, business or other reasons, a substitution is allowed with another Bonafide alumnus from the same school.

3.3 A team is only allowed one substitution per season. Once a player is substituted he cannot go back into that team.

3.4 The Team who played in the Divisional Final to win their place in the SA final cannot substitute a player for the SA final.

3.5 Admin must be informed immediately and must approve the substitution.

3.6 If a qualified pair cannot attend the SA Final, their spot goes to the team they defeated in the last round.

3.7 Winners proudly represent their school at the SA Final.

3. Measuring Devices

3.1 Players may use distance-measuring devices for yardages only.

3.2 Penalties apply if devices are used to measure slope, wind, temperature or other conditions, per the Rules of Golf.

4. Player Eligibility

4.1 General Requirements

4.1.1 Participants must be former pupils of the same school and attended the school for a minimum of 3 years. (no longer enrolled as a learner in 2026 or later seasons).

4.1.2 Participants must hold a valid active Golf RSA Handicapping Network Africa (HNA) handicap.

4.1.3 Participants must provide a valid handicap registration number during registration.

4.1.4 Participants must clear eligibility.

4.1.5 Participants must be in good standing at their club.

4.1.6 Participants must be at least 18 years old.

4.2 Ineligibility

4.2.1 Viewer-only access applies if any requirement is not met or if admin rejects eligibility.

4.3 Verification

4.3.1 Admin handles verification kindly and may request additional documents if needed.

4.3.2 Handicap verification involves cross-checking the HNA number against the official database for activity and accuracy.

4.3.2.1 If discrepancies arise (e.g., inactive handicap or unusual changes), admin may request recent score history, club confirmation or proof of updates to ensure fairness.

4.3.2.2 This process is quick and supportive—contact us with any questions.

5. Registration

5.1 Registration opens on 2 April 2026 and closes on 1 August 2026—all via the web-app.

5.2 Players provide full name, email address, South African mobile number, HNA handicap number, school name, handicap confirmation, city/town of residence, and postal code.

5.2.1 It is critically important that the correct city/town and **100% accurate postal code** are provided during registration. Geo-plotting for division assignments and Partner Pool matching is done **entirely based on the postal code entered**. Any inaccuracy may

result in incorrect grouping or matching—please double-check and ensure it is correct. We cannot stress this enough.

5.3 Teams consist of two players from the same school (mixed, all-male or all-female allowed; no limit on teams per school).

5.4 Teams form via partner invite (Player 1 invites Player 2 via name and mobile or email) or Partner Pool (admin/app matches by same school first, then approximately 50 km radius via postal code).

5.5 New schools can be added instantly in the; admin confirms later without delaying players.

6. Entry Fees and Payment

6.1 Entry fees are R1,500 per player (R3,000 per team)

6.2 Payment is by electronic payment portal or EFT.

6.3 Once a team is paid and included in the draw, no refunds are issued.

7. Tournament Format

7.1 The format is Better ball Matchplay throughout.

7.2 Divisions are assigned by geo-plotting for convenience (closest teams together where possible); each division has exactly 8 teams. **Postal code is used for geo-plotting** and therefore needs to be 100% correct—please ensure accuracy during registration. We cannot stress this enough.

7.3 Divisions are named Division 1, Division 2, Division 3, etc., but may be sponsored and renamed per the sponsor's request (sponsorship opportunities available).

7.4 Bracket Structure per Division (Double-Elimination Style)

7.4.1 Round 1: Four matches among 8 teams produce 4 winners to Winners Bracket and 4 losers to 2nd Chance Bracket.

7.4.2 Round 2: Two matches in Winners Bracket and two matches in 2nd Chance Bracket.

7.4.3 Round 3: The two undefeated teams from Winners Bracket Round 2 receive a bye to the semi-finals; two matches occur (winners of 2nd Chance Round 2 vs losers of Winners Round 2).

7.4.4 Round 4 (Semi-Finals): Two matches (Round 3 winners vs bye teams).

7.4.5 Round 5 (Division Final): One match to determine the division winner (no rematch).

7.4.6 A team is eliminated after two losses.

7.5 Round 6

7.5.1 Division winners are paired for playoffs (every two division winners play off).

7.5.2 If the number of divisions is odd, a 3-way playoff determines the remaining two SA Final spots.

7.5.3 Winners advance to the SA Final.

7.6 Home and Away

7.6.1 Home and away designations are drawn at the start of each round.

7.6.2 The home team books a GolfRSA-affiliated 18-hole or 9-hole course and confirms tee time (unless otherwise agreed).

7.6.3 If the home team cannot book, the match occurs at the away team's club or a mutually agreed neutral course.

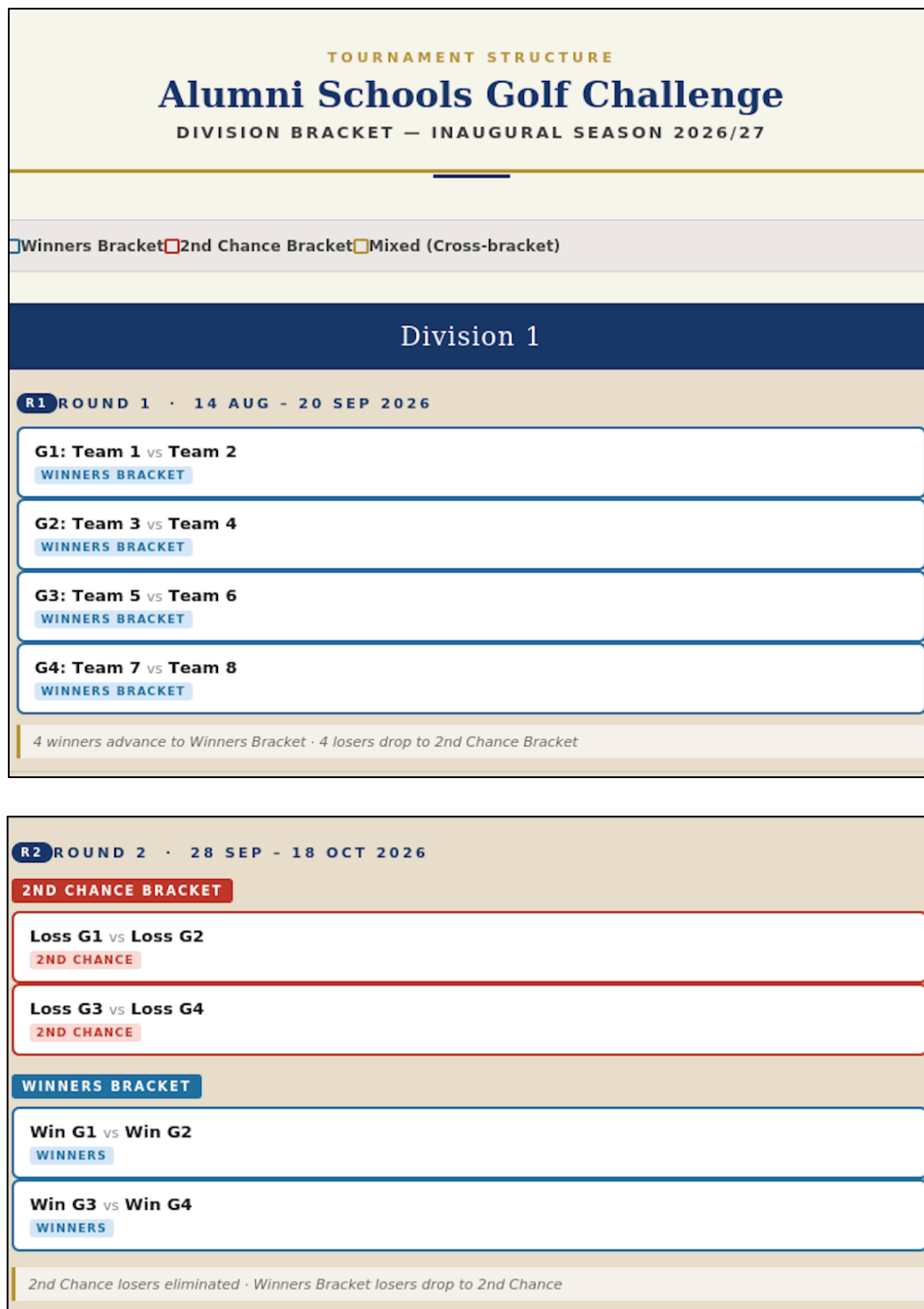
7.6.4 Local rules of the host course apply.

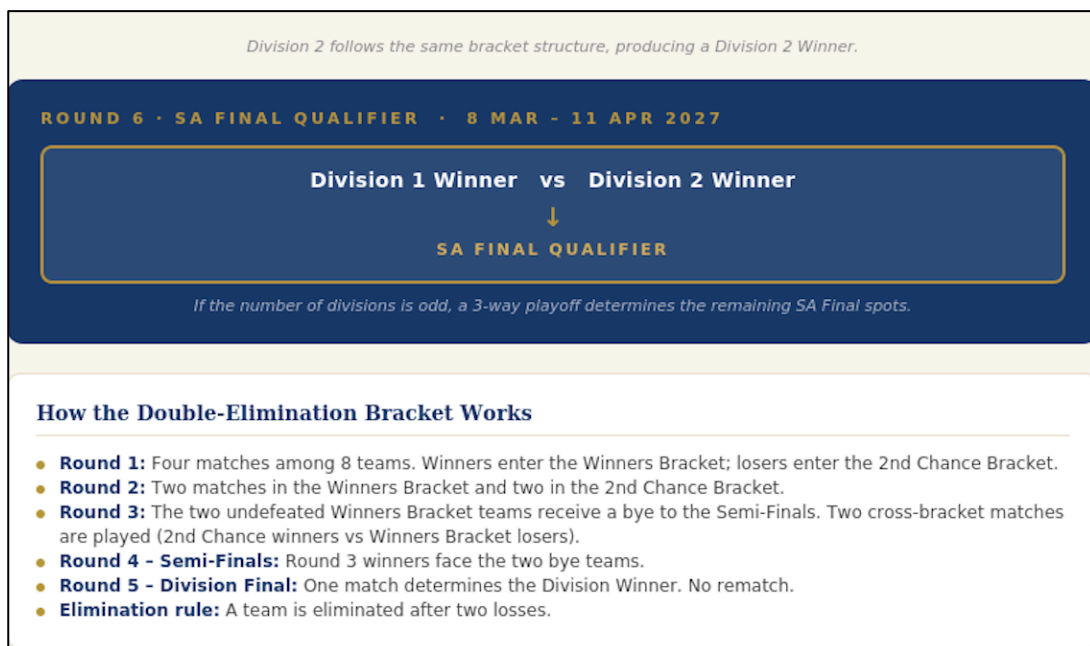
7.6.5 It is requested that home teams negotiate the cheapest possible rate with their club for the visiting team.

7.6.6 Each team is responsible for their own cost on the day of the match.

8. Sample Bracket Diagram

8.1 The following is a clear text representation of the bracket structure for a typical division (and Round 6 example).





9. Handicaps and Scoring

9.1 Handicap Calculation

9.1.1 Course Handicap is determined per World Handicap System rules using Handicap Index, Slope Rating, Course Rating, and tee selected (as published at the club or in the HNA app).

9.1.2 90% allowance is applied to each player's Course Handicap and rounded to the nearest whole number (0.5 and above rounds up).

9.1.3 Maximum playing handicap is 24 for men and 28 for women (higher handicaps play off the cap).

9.1.4 In a match, the lowest 90% Course Handicap among the four players is set to scratch; other players receive strokes equal to the difference.

9.1.4.i. Explanation – Match Play Betterball (Handicap Application)

In a match, each player first calculates **90% of their Course Handicap**.

The player with the **lowest adjusted handicap (90%)** plays **off scratch (0)**.

All other players receive strokes based on the **difference between their handicap and the lowest player's handicap**.

✓ Example Scenario

Player	Course Handicap	90% Allowance	Playing Handicap
Player A	10	9	0 (lowest – plays off scratch)
Player B	14	13	4 (13 – 9)
Player C	18	16	7 (16 – 9)
Player D	22	20	11 (20 – 9)

How it works in the match

- Player A (lowest) = **0 strokes**
- Player B = receives **4 strokes**
- Player C = receives **7 strokes**
- Player D = receives **11 strokes**

These strokes are allocated on the **stroke index holes** (hardest holes first).

Simple Summary (for players)

- Take **90% of your handicap**
- Lowest player goes to **0**
- Everyone else gets the **difference**
- Strokes are given on the **hardest holes**

9.2 Tee Selection

9.2.1 Players and team members may select different tees. Handicaps are reflected and published at the course or in the HNA app—the app displays these but does not adjust them automatically.

9.3 Scoring Format

9.3.1 The better (lower net) team score on each hole counts.

9.3.2 The hole is won by the team with the lower net score or halved if equal.

9.3.3 The match is won by the team that is more holes up than holes remaining.

9.4 Score Submission

- 9.4.1 Scores are entered hole-by-hole in the app (at least one player per team).
- 9.4.2 Manual scorecards are mandatory and serve as the official legal document.
- 9.4.3 Both teams must photograph and keep their scorecards.
- 9.4.4 In case of dispute, both teams upload their scorecards to admin for review.

10. Tied Matches and Countback

- 10.1 All Square after 18 holes results in sudden death playoff starting from Hole 1 or the next available hole as allocated by the club.
- 10.2 IF a sudden death playoff is not possible, use a countback from hole 18. If all 18 holes are not completed, then count back from hole 17 (or the last completed hole); the team that was last in the lead wins.
- 10.3 If that is not possible the winner will be determined by a chip off. Nearest to the pin wins.

11. Match Scheduling

11.1 Round Windows

- 11.1.1 Round 1: 14 August 2026 to 20 September 2026
- 11.1.2 Round 2: 28 September 2026 to 18 October 2026
- 11.1.3 Round 3: 26 October 2026 to 22 November 2026
- 11.1.4 Round 4: 30 November 2026 to 15 January 2027
- 11.1.5 Round 5: 1 February 2027 to 28 February 2027
- 11.1.6 Round 6: 8 March 2027 to 11 April 2027

11.2 Arrangement

- 11.2.1 Teams contact opponents via app chat and agree on date, time and venue within the window (details recorded in app).

11.3 Failure to Complete

- 11.3.1 If weather prevents a match from starting, a new date is allocated within the window if time allows.
 - 11.3.1.1 If insufficient time remains, the win is awarded to the team with the fewest losses overall.
 - 11.3.1.2 If losses are tied, a lucky draw determines the winner.
- 11.3.2 Admin may award a result fairly if no completion occurs and evidence (e.g., scheduling attempts) is reviewed.

12. Disputes and Appeals

- 12.1 in case a rule dispute cannot be resolved on the course, or by the course marshal or club representative during or after the game, log a dispute in the app.
- 12.2 Disputes are flagged directly in the app.
- 12.3 Admin reviews scorecards and seeks clarification from both teams.
- 12.4 Admin decisions are final.
- 12.5 An appeal process is built into the app for any queries, disputes or concerns.
 - 12.5.1 Players can contact admin directly from the app at any time with questions or to initiate an appeal.

12.5.2 All communications and resolutions are handled promptly and transparently through the app.

13. SA Final

13.1 The SA Final follows professional standards with no count-outs; ties are settled by playoff if possible.

13.2 Details (format, number of qualifiers, bracket, venue, dates) will be published by 15 August 2026 and depend on total entries.

13.3 It is a multi-day event (at least 2 rounds) around mid-May 2027.

13.4 Organizers arrange on-site accommodation, golf rounds and meals; players cover transport to/from the venue, caddies and carts unless otherwise informed.

13.5 One practice round is provided.

13.6 Social events occur every evening except one, with live entertainment on at least one evening.

13.7 SA Final participants must sign the standalone Code of Conduct.

13.8 Players are responsible for travel costs and compliance with venue health protocols and associated costs.

14. Player Conduct

14.1 Participants are expected to uphold golf's values of respect, honesty, integrity and fun.

14.2 Full details are in the standalone Code of Conduct published in the app.

14.3 Environmental respect is encouraged: repair divots, rake bunkers and leave the course better than found—no trace left behind.

15. General Provisions

15.1 Amendments are notified via the app; continued participation constitutes acceptance.

15.2 Force majeure, privacy (data used solely for tournament administration and kept secure), liability (participation at own risk) and governing law (Republic of South Africa) apply.

16. Photographs and Media

16.1 By entering, players grant organizers permission to photograph or video for tournament promotion and advertising in any media, without further approval or payment.

16.2 Players release organizers from related claims.

17. Sponsorship

17.1 Sponsorship opportunities are available across stages, including division naming—contact admin to get involved!

18. Contact

18.1 Email: admin@asc.com

19. Acceptance

19.1 By registering, you confirm you have read, understood and agree to these rules.

